

Topic E Are criminals born or made?

1. Explaining the question: Are criminals born or made?

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a causes of criminal behaviour including:
 - i biological explanations of criminality (genetics, XYY chromosome abnormality, twin studies)
 - ii social explanations of criminality (family patterns, childrearing strategies, self-fulfilling prophecy)
- b biological and social explanations of criminality, by comparing them
- c the nature-nurture debate in relation to an individual's tendency toward criminality.

Note: In the examination, students may be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

2. Investigating the question

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the aim, procedure and findings (results and/or conclusions) and evaluation of
 - i Sigall and Ostrove (1975) *Beautiful but dangerous: Effects of offender attractiveness and nature of the crime on juridic judgments*
 - ii Madon et al (2004) *Self-fulfilling prophecies: the synergistic accumulative effect of parents' beliefs on children's drinking behavior*
 - iii Theilgaard (1984) *A psychological study of the personalities of XYY- and XXY*
- b the ethical and practical problems associated with biological and social research into criminality, and the gathering of information from convicted offenders.

3. Why psychology matters

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the purpose, process and effectiveness of offender profiling as a method used to help catch criminals
- b the use of offender profiling in the case of John Duffy (David Canter)
- c the role of a forensic psychologist including
 - i who they might work for
 - ii what they do
 - iii skills required
 - iv qualifications required
 - v chartered status
 - vi how they might help to treat offenders.

4. Exploring it further

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the effects of race, accent and appearance/attractiveness on jury decision making.